

Ohio River Trail Council Cycling Club

Deckers Creek Trail

38-Mile Bike Trail Ride

City/State: Morgantown, West Virginia

Counties: Marion, Monongalia, Preston

Date: Sunday, July 15, 2012

Departure Time: 9:30 a.m.

Surface: Crushed limestone, asphalt

Meeting Point: Hazel Ruby McQuain Riverfront Park, Morgantown, WV. ([Google map](#))

RSVP: ortctrailride@gmail.com



Come out for a ride! This is part of a trail ride series sponsored by the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) intended to bring awareness to the wonderful trails in our 4-state region (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia).

All riders are welcome for this free, rails-to-trails, moderate-paced ride!

The Decker's Creek Trail is a National Recreation Trail built in 1999. The trail follows Decker's Creek from downtown Morgantown to Reedsville, WV. The Deckers Creek Trail was originally the Morgantown & Kingwood Railroad carrying coal and coke, glass, sand, limestone and other items to distant markets.

For this ride...

Join us, as we visit the Deckers Creek Trail for a 38-mile round-trip beginning at Hazel Ruby McQuain Riverfront Park in Morgantown and then follow Deckers Creek upstream to Reedsville, WV. Outside of Morgantown, the landscape is very scenic with many hardwood trees and rocky outcroppings. This trail offers an 1,000 ft. incline (2% incline) over 19 miles. The trail includes nearly three miles of paved surface travelling through Morgantown and continues south of the City with a crushed limestone surface.

Features of Interest:

The Deckers Creek Trail travels through rhododendron and hemlock groves, deciduous forests, into more open fields and farmlands in Preston County, WV. The trail provides a close-up view of Greer Limestone, an active limestone mine. Near the communities of Masontown and Bretz, the trail passes an abandoned row of coke ovens, remnants from a large coal-mining industry. The Bretz Coke Ovens are listed as a National Historic

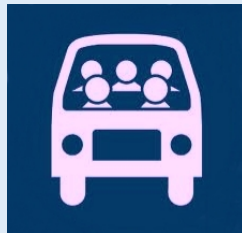
Landmark and are currently being considered for restoration & interpretation.

Deckers Creek is a scenic tributary to the Monongahela River in north central West Virginia. From its headwaters outside the historic town of Arthurdale, Deckers Creek meanders through Preston County into Monongalia County where it descends through a steep scenic gorge. This beautiful section of Deckers Creek is filled with waterfalls, boulders, and rock slides, contains world class kayaking, and is frequented by kayakers, rock climbers, bikers, and swimmers. From here, Deckers Creek passes through several communities and into Morgantown, where it empties into the Monongahela River. Don't forget your camera!

Don't forget your camera!

Carpooling:

We are glad to facilitate carpooling as well. Just RSVP or contact the ORTC at ortctrailride@ohiorivertrail.org. Carpooling meeting locations are either Beaver, Cranberry Twp., Moon Twp., or Pittsburgh, Pa.



Weather & Cancellations:

The weather forecast is mostly sunny and 85 degrees. Please visit the [ORTC website](#) for cancellations before you depart for the trail. In addition, persons who RSVP will be sent an email regarding schedule changes. Rides that are cancelled due to inclement weather are usually rescheduled for the next day for Saturday rides or the following week for Sunday rides.

Trailhead Address and Directions:

Hazel Ruby McQuain Riverfront Park Trailhead is located at 185 Garrett St, Morgantown, WV 26505.

[Morgantown Trailhead](#)



GPS: 39.629695,-79.95988

Drive Time:

Drive time from Moon Township: 90 minutes
Drive time from Pittsburgh: 85 minutes
Drive time from Monaca: 110 minutes

Website Links:

<http://www.montrails.org/>

<http://www.traillink.com/trail/mon-river-rail-trail-system-deckers-creek-trail.aspx>

[Deckers Creek Trail Map](#)

Lunch:

We will meet for lunch after the ride.

Ohio River Trail Council

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is a Pennsylvania based non-profit, volunteer-led corporation whose mission is to establish, promote, protect and preserve a multi-use trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the "La Belle Riviere" or the Ohio River and its tributaries.

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is currently planning & developing a 41-mile bike and water trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the Ohio River, from Coraopolis, Pa (near Pittsburgh) to Ohioville, Pa. (near East Liverpool, OH). The ORT is part of the *Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area*, *Lewis & Clark Trail* and is a candidate for part of the *U.S. Bicycle Route 50, Pittsburgh to Cleveland Trail*, and a portion of the *Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh spur*. The proposed ORT will also follow parts of the "*Great Path*" and the *Lincoln Highway*. The ORT will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia). Specifically, the proposed Ohio River Trail will connect the *Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway* in Columbiana County, Ohio to the *Great Allegheny Passage* in Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol.

**Donations**

The ORTC is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to form an alliance with us to capitalize on our strengths in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns. Please visit www.ohiorivertrail.org for additional information and a [donation form](#).



Ohio River Trail Cycling Club

The Ohio River Trail Cycling Club is a recreational club that promotes health, wellness and fitness in our community through a variety of biking events. Our goal is to encourage cyclists of all abilities to explore the wonderful opportunities of the region - from the Heritage Trail of Pittsburgh to the rural scenery of the 4-state area, including Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The club provides cyclists with a diversity of riding experiences. Ohio River Trail Council members can be seen on city bikes, comfort bikes, cyclocross bikes, hybrids, mountain bikes, recumbents, road bikes, touring bikes and tandems.

The ORTC Cycling Club supports and promotes safe bicycle riding. If you have been inactive for several years or are currently under medical care, please consult your doctor before starting a new exercise program. It is highly recommended to always carry water and food. In addition, please bring a spare tube, pump and tools to replace a flat tire. A Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) approved bicycle helmet securely fitted and fastened is required on all ORTC Trail Series Rides. In order to participate in our events please print and sign the [OHIO RIVER TRAIL COUNCIL CYCLING CLUB RELEASE](#) and mail to ORTC 1100 Pennsylvania Av Monaca, Pa 15061. The ORTC club members serve as ambassadors for bicycling every time we ride thus projecting a positive image of bicycling to the public. Always follow the rules of the road!

About the Trail Ride Series:

- Trails rides are 10-50 miles in length.
- Moderate and self-paced rides located within a 2 hour drive of Pittsburgh, Pa.
- Meet for lunch or dinner either mid-way or at the end.
- Two - four rides per month on Saturday or Sunday.
- Feel free to forward this email. This publication is intended for widespread distribution.

Example rides include the [Allegheny Highlands Trail](#), [Allegheny River & Samuel Justus Trails](#), [Armstrong Trail](#), [Arrowhead Trail](#), [Bike and Hike Trail](#), [Butler-Freeport Trail](#), [C & O Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Conotton Creek Trail](#), [Deckers Creek Trail](#), [Ghost Town Trail](#), [Greater Wheeling Trail](#), [Hoodlebug Trail](#), [Little Beaver Creek Greenway](#), [Lower Trail](#), [Mahoning Shadow Trail](#), [Maurice K. Goddard State Park Trail](#), [Mill Creek MetroParks Bikeway](#), [Montour Trail](#), [Ohio & Erie Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Oil Creek State Park Trail](#), [Panhandle Trail](#), [Pine Creek Trail](#), [Sandy Creek Trail](#), [Stavich Trail](#), [Steel Valley Trail](#), [Three Rivers Heritage Trail](#), [Western Reserve Greenway Trumbull MetroParks](#), [West Penn Trail](#), and [Youghiogheny River Trail](#).

Ride Schedule

Please refer to the provisional ORTC Trail Series [Ride Schedule](#) or ORTC [Event Calendar](#) for additional dates and times. Click here to view the [ORTC meeting schedule](#).

Membership

To join the Ohio River Trail Council and become a member of the ORTC Cycling Club please download a [membership application](#) and mail your contribution to the ORTC office. Feel free to forward this message to a friend.



Correspondence

Please visit our [website](#) and [register](#) to receive ORTC correspondence. Thank you for your support.



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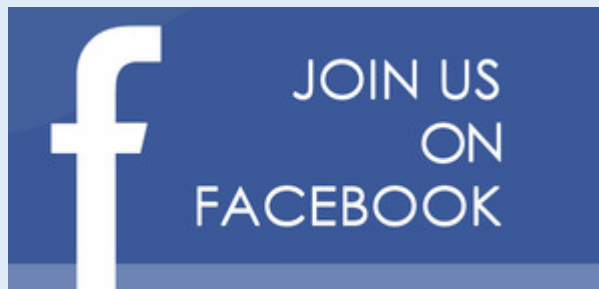
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For questions and comments please contact:

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